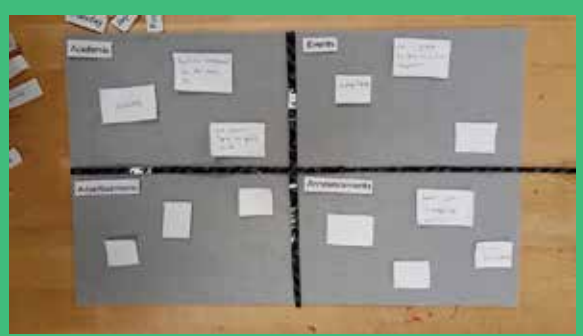
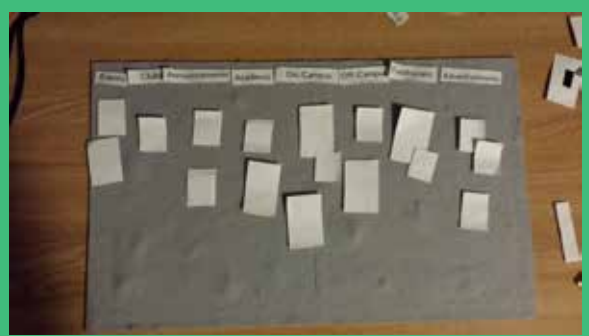
Research Methods

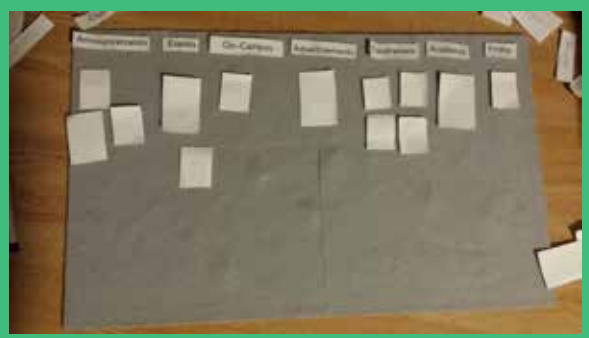
Bulletin board velcro model
Photo documentation over time
Poster as survey implementation

Findings

Grid format (x-axis and y-axis usage)
Segmented or use of explicit divisions
Avoiding overabundance of categories
x-axis: day of the week
y-axis: categories or long-term dates
Lack of maintenance on many bulletins







From these student-created bulletin boards, we found a variety of similarities and differences between each person's ideal board. The majority of them included the days of the week at the top horizontal axis to organize the info, and many also had categories of posters on the left vertical axis. Nearly all of the participants utilized the black dividers to visually distinguishe the categories. The boards each varied in number of organization methods used. For example, the on the bottom left only used four categories while the second one from the top left used eight. Some people also suggested combining categories that might have too much overlap, or to utilize fluid divisions that change depending on the content amount.

By occasionally taking photos of some select bulletin boards on campus over a period of 1-2 weeks, we found that the boards are not very well-maintained, as shown by the lack of care and organization for the board's content. The three photos below show the changes over time, with our poster survey in the center. The first photo was taken right after posting the survey, but it also reveals a clear lack of organization on the board. The second photo shows that other people have begun placing their own posters on top of others (even using the same pushpins). The final photo shows that people just take pushpins for their own and literally leave some hanging. None of our surveys received any responses, despite being up for 1-2 weeks.

Ji Tae Kim, Jasper Tom, Albert Yang